

Start of section headers:	6788 (bytes into file)
Flags:	0x0
Size of this header:	52 (bytes)
Size of program headers:	32 (bytes)
Number of program headers:	8
Size of section headers:	40 (bytes)
Number of section headers:	30
Section header string table index:	27

—Balasubramanian C, cbaluid@gmail.com

Play music from the command line

Many of us use *mplayer* to watch videos and listen to music from the command line but the recent versions of VLC player are shipped with an *ncurses*-based interface called *nvlc*.

The advantage of *nvlc* over *mplayer* is that it provides a much better user interface; you can view the playlist and also watch the progress of the song in a much more intuitive manner.

To use *nvlc* type:

```
$nvlc <file name or Folder containing the media files or a playlist>
```

Now enjoy the music from the command line.

—Kunal Ghosh, kunal.t2@gmail.com

A command to change the user

In Linux, if you want to change the user, you need to log out of the GUI. Now, if you know the password of that user, you don't need to log out from the GUI to change the user from the command line.

For example, if the current user is *root* and you want to change to *stud* user, type the following command:

```
$ su stud
```

You will then be prompted for your password.

```
$ enter the password : *****
```

If the password is correct, it will move to the *stud* user. Now you can access the *stud* files, *dir*, etc, without logging out of the current user.

If you want to switch back to the original user, you can use the same command line or simply press *ctrl+d*.

```
$ su root
```

—Thilak, thilak206@gmail.com

Restore Linux booting

If you are in the habit of trying out the various flavours of Linux, then there may be times when the boot

sector is lost or overwritten by Windows. Even the SUSE *Repair* or *Rescue* options do not help. I have always followed this method to restore booting.

Using the Linux installation CD/DVD, go to Shell and type *grub*. Then issue the following commands:

```
# root (hd0, X)
```

where X is one minus the Linux Root Partition number

```
# setup (hd0)
# quit
```

After rebooting, you will be back to Linux.

—V S Nagasayanam, vsayanam@gmail.com

View the contents of a file inside a ZIP archive

To view the contents of a file inside a ZIP archive without extracting it into the local file system, use the following command:

```
unzip -p
```

For example, the command given below will print out the contents of *test.txt* into the console.
test.txt file is a file inside the *test.zip* archive.

```
unzip -p test.zip test.txt
```

—Sree Pratheep, sreepratheep@gmail.com

View information about the motherboard and CPU

To view exhaustive information about your hardware, use the following command:

```
sudo dmidecode | more
```

dmidecode's purpose is to report "information about your system's hardware as described in your system BIOS according to the SMBIOS/DMI standard."

—Ayush Maheswari, ayush.hakmn@gmail.com

END

Share Your Linux Recipes!

The joy of using Linux is in finding ways to get around problems—take them head on, defeat them! We invite you to share your tips and tricks with us for publication in LFY so that they can reach a wider audience. Your tips could be related to administration, programming, troubleshooting or general tweaking. Submit them at www.linuxforu.com. The sender of each published tip will get an LFY T-shirt.